

Day 37 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Elections, Judiciary in India, and Rule of Law

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Election Commission (Article 324), the Supreme Court/High Court judiciary (Articles 124-147, 214-231), and the foundational concept of Rule of Law. Real exam evidence favours testing these via comparison-and-elimination against similar bodies or borrowed-from-country mix-ups.

Q: What is the 'Rule of Law', per A.V. Dicey's three classical principles?

A: (1) Supremacy of law / absence of arbitrary power — no one can be punished except for a clear breach of law established through ordinary legal process; (2) Equality before the law — everyone, regardless of rank or status, is subject to the same law and ordinary courts; (3) Predominance of the legal spirit — individual rights are best secured not by abstract constitutional declarations alone, but by their actual enforcement and protection through court decisions.

Q: Real exam: Which features are correctly matched to the country India borrowed them from — UK/Bicameral Legislature, USSR/Independent Judiciary, Australia/Five Year Plans, US/Removal procedure for SC and HC Judges?

A: UK → Bicameral Legislature is CORRECT. US → the procedure for removal of Supreme Court and High Court Judges is also CORRECT. The other two are WRONG: Independent Judiciary is actually borrowed from the USA (not USSR), and Five Year Plans are borrowed from the USSR/Soviet Union (not Australia) — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Is the Election Commission a constitutional body? What about the National Development Council and NITI Aayog?

A: The Election Commission IS a constitutional body (established under Article 324). The National Development Council (NDC) and NITI Aayog are BOTH extra-constitutional/non-constitutional bodies — created by executive/Cabinet resolutions, not by the Constitution itself — confirmed by a real exam question testing exactly this distinction (alongside the Finance Commission, which like the EC, IS constitutional, under Article 280).

Q: How is the Chief Election Commissioner protected to ensure independence, and how can other Election Commissioners be removed?

A: The CEC can be removed only in the same manner and on the same grounds as a Supreme Court judge (i.e., via the impeachment-style process), and his/her service conditions cannot be changed to their disadvantage after appointment — both designed to insulate the CEC from executive pressure. Other Election Commissioners can be removed on the CEC's recommendation.

Q: What are the qualifications and retirement age for a Supreme Court judge, per Article 124?

A: Must have been a High Court judge for at least 5 years, OR an advocate in a High Court for at least 10 years, OR (in the President's opinion) be a distinguished jurist. Appointed by the President on the recommendation of the Supreme Court Collegium. Retirement age: 65 years (compare: High Court judges retire at 62 years).

Q: Real exam: Under Article 136, what special power does the Supreme Court have?

A: The power to grant 'Special Leave to Appeal' (SLP) from any judgment, decree, determination, or order passed by any court or tribunal in India (except military tribunals/courts-martial) — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Which categories of Constitutional Amendment (under Article 368) require ratification by not less than half of the State Legislatures, in addition to Parliament's special majority?

A: Amendments that touch the powers/provisions of the JUDICIARY (Supreme Court and High Courts) and amendments that CHANGE THE POWERS OF THE STATES (federal distribution of powers) — both require State ratification, confirmed by a real exam question. By contrast, amendments merely adding a new principle, or even altering Fundamental Rights, do NOT require State ratification — only Parliament's special majority.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A.V. Dicey's 'Rule of Law' includes which of the following principles?

- A. Supremacy of the Executive over courts
- B. Equality before the law for all persons ✓**
- C. Special legal immunity for government officials
- D. Laws can be applied retroactively without restriction

Explanation: Equality before the law. [medium, web-research]

2. Which of the following feature-to-country pairings is CORRECT?

- A. USSR — Independent Judiciary

B. Australia — Five Year Plans

C. UK — Bicameral Legislature ✓

D. US — Bicameral Legislature

Explanation: UK — Bicameral Legislature. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. The procedure for removal of Supreme Court and High Court Judges was borrowed from:

A. UK

B. USSR

C. Australia

D. US ✓

Explanation: US. [medium, question-bank-2026]

4. Which of the following is a CONSTITUTIONAL body (i.e., established directly by the Constitution)?

A. National Development Council

B. NITI Aayog

C. Election Commission ✓

D. Both NDC and NITI Aayog

Explanation: Election Commission (Article 324) — NDC and NITI Aayog are both extra-constitutional. [hard, question-bank-2024]

5. The Chief Election Commissioner can be removed from office only:

A. By a simple Cabinet decision

B. In the same manner and on the same grounds as a Supreme Court judge ✓

C. By the Prime Minister directly

D. By a State Legislature resolution

Explanation: Same manner/grounds as a Supreme Court judge. [medium, web-research]

6. A Supreme Court judge retires at the age of, while a High Court judge retires at:

A. 65 years; 62 years ✓

B. 62 years; 65 years

C. 60 years; 58 years

D. 70 years; 65 years

Explanation: SC judges retire at 65; HC judges at 62. [medium, web-research]

7. Under Article 136, the Supreme Court has the power to:

A. Amend the Constitution directly

B. Grant Special Leave to Appeal from any court or tribunal in India (except military tribunals) ✓

C. Dissolve a State Legislature

D. Appoint State Governors

Explanation: Grant Special Leave to Appeal (SLP). [medium, question-bank-2017]

8. An amendment to the Constitution that changes the powers of the States requires ratification by:

A. A simple majority of Parliament only

B. Not less than half of the State Legislatures, in addition to Parliament's special majority ✓

C. Unanimous consent of all States

D. The Supreme Court's prior approval

Explanation: Not less than half the State Legislatures, plus Parliament's special majority. [hard, question-bank-2026]

9. Does an amendment merely abolishing or altering Fundamental Rights require ratification by State Legislatures?

A. Yes, always

B. No — only Parliament's special majority is needed ✓

C. Only if more than 5 rights are affected

D. Only during a National Emergency

Explanation: No — only Parliament's special majority. [hard, question-bank-2026]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Ratio and Proportion

READING MATERIAL

Ratio & Proportion is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills, and real exam evidence shows it's tested through several distinct shapes, not just 'simplify this ratio'. Learn each shape as its own method.

Q: Real exam (2025): A man spends Rs.500 buying 12 tables and chairs. One table costs Rs.50, one chair costs Rs.40. Find the ratio of chairs to tables purchased.

A: Let tables= t , chairs= c . $t+c=12$ and $50t+40c=500$ (i.e. $5t+4c=50$). Substitute $t=12-c$: $5(12-c)+4c=50 \rightarrow 60-5c+4c=50 \rightarrow c=10$, so $t=2$. Ratio chairs:tables = $10:2 = 5:1$.

Q: Method — combining two ratios that share a common term: If $a:b=3:5$ and $b:c=7:8$, find $a:c$.

A: To chain two ratios, scale each so the SHARED term (b) matches in both. Here b is 5 in the first ratio and 7 in the second — $\text{LCM}(5,7)=35$. Scale $a:b=3:5$ by $\times 7 \rightarrow a:b=21:35$. Scale $b:c=7:8$ by $\times 5 \rightarrow b:c=35:40$. Now $a:b:c = 21:35:40$, so $a:c = 21:40$.

Q: Method — continued proportion (three terms in one ratio): If $a/10 = b/15 = c/20$, find $a:b:c$.

A: All three fractions equal the same constant, so $a:b:c$ is simply $10:15:20$, which reduces to $2:3:4$ (dividing by the HCF, 5).

Q: Method — chaining two ratios via a shared term: If $A:B=3:4$ and $B:C=8:9$, find $A:C$.

A: B is 4 in the first ratio and 8 in the second — scale the first ratio so B matches: multiply $A:B=3:4$ by 2 to get $A:B=6:8$. Now both ratios share $B=8$: $A:B:C = 6:8:9$. So $A:C = 6:9 = 2:3$.

Q: Method — mixture/alloy adjustment (add a pure ingredient to shift a ratio): A mixture of 60 L has acid:water = $2:1$. How much water must be added to make the ratio $1:2$?

A: Acid:water = $2:1$ in 60L means acid=40L, water=20L. We're only adding water (acid stays at 40L). We want acid:water = $1:2$, i.e. water = $2 \times \text{acid} = 80\text{L}$. Water to add = $80-20 = 60\text{L}$.

Q: Method — simplest form of an age ratio: Azhagan is 50 years old, his son is 10. What is the simplest ratio of their ages?

A: $50:10$ reduces (divide both by 10) to $5:1$.

Q: Method — finding an unknown in a proportion (cross-multiplication): If the numbers 2, 5, x , 20 (in that order) are in proportion, find x .

A: In proportion, $2:5 = x:20$, so $2 \times 20 = 5 \times x \rightarrow 40 = 5x \rightarrow x = 8$. (General rule: in $a:b=c:d$, $a \times d = b \times c$.)

Q: Method — the '4th proportional': Find the 4th proportional to 4, 16, and 7.

A: The 4th proportional x satisfies $4:16 = 7:x \rightarrow 4x = 16 \times 7 = 112 \rightarrow x = 28$.

Q: Method — splitting a total using a 3-part ratio and a given average: Three numbers are in ratio $3:5:7$ and their average is 60. Find the smallest number.

A: Average of 60 over 3 numbers means their total = 180. Split 180 in ratio $3:5:7$ (15 parts total): each part = $180/15 = 12$. Smallest = $3 \times 12 = 36$.

Q: Method — 'duplicate ratio' (squaring a ratio): What is the duplicate ratio of $2:7$?

A: The duplicate ratio of $a:b$ is $a^2:b^2$. So the duplicate ratio of $2:7$ is $4:49$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A woman spends Rs.620 buying 14 pens and notebooks. One pen costs Rs.30, one notebook costs Rs.50. Find the ratio of notebooks to pens purchased.

- A. 2:5
- B. 5:2 ✓**
- C. 3:4
- D. 4:3

Explanation: $p+n=14$; $30p+50n=620 \rightarrow 3p+5n=62$. Substitute $p=14-n$: $3(14-n)+5n=62 \rightarrow 42+2n=62 \rightarrow n=10$, $p=4$. Ratio notebooks:pens = $10:4 = 5:2$. [hard, authored]

2. If $x/8 = y/12 = z/20$, find $x:y:z$ in lowest terms.

- A. 2:3:5 ✓**
- B. 8:12:20
- C. 4:6:10
- D. 1:2:3

Explanation: $x:y:z = 8:12:20$, which reduces (divide by HCF=4) to $2:3:5$. [easy, authored]

3. If $P:Q = 2:3$ and $Q:R = 9:10$, find $P:R$.

A. 3:5 ✓

B. 2:5

C. 3:10

D. 9:20

Explanation: Scale $P:Q=2:3$ by 3 to get $P:Q=6:9$, matching $Q=9$ from $Q:R=9:10$. So $P:Q:R=6:9:10$, giving $P:R=6:10=3:5$. [medium, authored]

4. A 40 L mixture has milk:water = 3:1. How much water must be added to change the ratio to 3:2?

A. 5 L

B. 10 L ✓

C. 8 L

D. 6 L

Explanation: Milk:water=3:1 in 40L means milk=30L, water=10L. Milk stays fixed; we want water= $(2/3) \times \text{milk} = (2/3) \times 30 = 20$ L. Water to add = $20 - 10 = 10$ L. [hard, authored]

5. If 5, 8, x, 24 are in proportion, find x.

A. 12.5

B. 15 ✓

C. 16

D. 20

Explanation: $5:8 = x:24 \rightarrow 5 \times 24 = 8x \rightarrow 120 = 8x \rightarrow x = 15$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the 4th proportional to 3, 12, and 9.

A. 27

B. 36 ✓

C. 30

D. 33

Explanation: $3:12 = 9:x \rightarrow 3x = 12 \times 9 = 108 \rightarrow x = 36$. [easy, authored]

7. Three numbers are in the ratio 2:3:4 and their average is 45. Find the largest number.

A. 40

B. 50

C. 60 ✓

D. 45

Explanation: Average 45 over 3 numbers means total=135. 9 parts total, each part=15. Largest = $4 \times 15 = 60$. [medium, authored]

8. What is the duplicate ratio of 3:5?

A. 6:10

B. 9:25 ✓

C. 9:10

D. 3:25

Explanation: Duplicate ratio = square each term: $3^2:5^2 = 9:25$. [easy, authored]

9. A sum of Rs.450 is divided among 100 boys and girls, each boy getting Rs.5.10 and each girl Rs.3.60. Find the number of girls.

A. 20

B. 30

C. 40 ✓

D. 50

Explanation: Let girls=g, boys=100-g. $3.6g + 5.1(100-g) = 450 \rightarrow 3.6g + 510 - 5.1g = 450 \rightarrow -1.5g = -60 \rightarrow g = 40$. [hard, authored]

10. A father's age (40) to his daughter's age (8) — what is the simplest ratio?

A. 5:1 ✓

B. 8:1

C. 4:1

D. 10:1

Explanation: 40:8 reduces ($\div 8$) to 5:1. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose (Drama): "Old Man River" — Dorothy Deming

READING MATERIAL

A short drama about the Marshall family in Alberta, whose home faces a rising flood while the parents are away — testing the courage and calm of the children and young neighbours left to handle the emergency, including a tense rescue of a 9-year-old girl, Sara Field.

Q: Who wrote "Old Man River", and what type of literary work is it (distinct from most other Unit VII pieces)?

A: Dorothy Deming. It is a DRAMA (a play script), not a short story or poem.

Q: What natural disaster occurs in the drama, and where is the play set?

A: A flood. The play is set in the Marshall household (in Alberta).

Q: Who is Amy Marshall, and how many children/young people are involved in the rescue situation overall?

A: Amy Marshall is the ELDEST child in the family. Five children/young people are involved in the rescue situation in total.

Q: What is Jim Hall's role in the drama, and what does the radio report about the river?

A: Jim Hall is a Junior Red Cross emergency team member. The radio reports that the river has CROSSED FLOOD STAGE.

Q: What happens to the house's power supply and stove during the emergency, and what does Betty use for lighting instead?

A: The power supply goes OUT. The house has an OIL-OPERATED stove. Betty uses a flashlight and candles for lighting during the outage.

Q: Who is Sara Field, how old is she, and where was she rescued from?

A: Sara Field is a 9-year-old girl who needs to be rescued during the flood — she was on the playhouse porch before being rescued.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Old Man River" was written by:

A. Dorothy Parker

B. Dorothy Deming ✓

C. Ruskin Bond

D. O. Henry

Explanation: Dorothy Deming. [easy, web-research]

2. What natural disaster occurs in "Old Man River"?

A. Earthquake

B. Cyclone

C. Flood ✓

D. Fire

Explanation: Flood. [easy, web-research]

3. Where does the play "Old Man River" take place?

A. A field school

B. The Marshall household ✓

C. A city hospital

D. A railway station

Explanation: The Marshall household. [medium, web-research]

4. How many children/young people are involved in the rescue situation in the drama?

A. 3

B. 4

C. 5 ✓

D. 6

Explanation: 5. [medium, web-research]

5. Who is Amy Marshall in the drama?

A. A nurse

B. The youngest girl

C. A Red Cross member

D. The eldest child ✓

Explanation: The eldest child. [medium, web-research]

6. What is Jim Hall's role in the drama?

A. Police Officer

B. Red Cross Volunteer (adult)

C. Junior Red Cross emergency team member ✓

D. Soldier

Explanation: Junior Red Cross emergency team member. [medium, web-research]

7. What did the radio report about the river?

A. It was dry

B. It had crossed flood stage ✓

C. It was clean

D. It was freezing

Explanation: It had crossed flood stage. [medium, web-research]

8. What happened to the power supply in the Marshall house during the flood?

A. It worked fine

B. It brightened

C. It fluctuated

D. It went out ✓

Explanation: It went out. [medium, web-research]

9. How old is Sara Field, and where was she before being rescued?

A. 8 years old; kitchen

B. 9 years old; playhouse porch ✓

C. 10 years old; attic

D. 7 years old; roof

Explanation: 9 years old; playhouse porch. [hard, web-research]

10. What did Betty use for lighting during the power outage?

A. Lamps

B. Torches only

C. Flashlight and candles ✓

D. A lighter

Explanation: Flashlight and candles. [medium, web-research]